

FREE GUIDE

The Local Trades Business Guide to Page 1 on Google

How HVAC, Plumbing, Electrical, Roofing, Cleaning &
Landscaping Companies Get Found First — and Stay There

- The 5-point Google ranking system every trades business needs
 - The #1 mistake killing your Google Maps visibility
 - How to outrank competitors with 3x more reviews
 - The exact GBP checklist that moves you up the map
 - What page 1 is worth in dollars — by trade

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Why Most Local Trades Businesses Never See Page 1

Here's the uncomfortable truth: 97% of people searching for a local plumber, HVAC tech, or roofer never scroll past the first page of Google results. They click the first 3 listings, and if none of them answer fast enough, they move to the next one down the list.

If your business doesn't show up on page 1 for your main keyword, you're invisible to almost every potential customer in your area. You might as well not have a website.

The average HVAC company ranking on page 2 misses an estimated 40-60 inbound calls per month. At a \$350 average job value, that's \$14,000-\$21,000 in revenue every month going straight to whoever ranks above them.

The Good News

Most of your competitors are making the same basic mistakes. This guide shows you exactly what those mistakes are and what to fix first. These aren't technical tricks — they're the fundamentals that Google uses to decide who ranks #1 in your market.

In most markets across the US, the competition for local trades keywords is beatable. Page 1 slots are available right now that any business with the right setup could take — including yours.

The 5-Point Local SEO System

Google uses hundreds of ranking signals but for local trades businesses, five factors account for roughly 80% of your ranking. Fix these five and you'll outrank most of your competition.

1

Google Business Profile

The single biggest factor for Maps rankings. An incomplete GBP is the #1 reason trades businesses don't show in the top 3.

2

Google Reviews

Quantity, recency, and your response rate all matter. 40+ reviews with 4.7+ rating puts you in contention for position 1.

3

On-Page Keywords

Your website needs to mention your trade, your city, and your services in the right places — title tag, H1, first paragraph.

4

Local Citations

Consistent name, address, and phone number across 20+ directories tells Google you're a real, established local business.

5

Website Speed & Mobile

Google penalizes slow or broken mobile sites. If your site takes more than 3 seconds to load on a phone, you're losing rankings.

The Google Business Profile Checklist

Your Google Business Profile is the #1 ranking factor for Maps results. Most trades businesses have a GBP that's 40-60% incomplete. Every missing field is a missed ranking opportunity.

Complete these in order — each one adds ranking power:

- Business name matches exactly what's on your invoices and signage
- Primary category set to your exact trade (e.g. 'HVAC contractor', not just 'Contractor')
- 5+ secondary categories added (e.g. Air conditioning repair, Heating contractor, Furnace repair)
- Business description written with your trade + city + 3 main services mentioned
- All service areas listed (your city + 5-8 surrounding cities)
- Services section fully filled out with individual service names and descriptions
- 10+ photos uploaded — truck, team, job sites, before/after
- Business hours complete including holiday hours
- Messaging turned on so customers can text your listing
- Q&A; section seeded with 5 common customer questions and your answers
- Google Posts published at least once per week
- Phone number matches your website and all directories exactly

GBP Verification: Google will mail a postcard to your business address with a 6-digit verification code. When it arrives, reply to biz@gofieldwise.com with the code — we handle the rest. Never call.

The Review System That Moves You Up the Map

Google reviews are the second most powerful ranking factor. But it's not just about the number of reviews — it's about recency, rating, and how you respond.

What Google's Algorithm Looks For

Volume	40+ reviews	Businesses with 40+ reviews appear in the Maps 3-pack 3x more often than those with under 20
Rating	4.7 or higher	Below 4.5 and Google begins filtering you out of competitive searches
Recency	Weekly activity	Reviews older than 90 days carry less weight — you need a steady stream
Response rate	100% responded	Responding to every review — good and bad — is a confirmed ranking signal
Keywords	Service mentions	Reviews that mention your trade and city help you rank for those terms

How to Get More Reviews Without Begging

After every completed job, send this text to the customer:

"Hi [name], thanks for choosing [Business]! If you had a good experience, a quick Google review would really help us out. Here's the link: [your Google review link]. Takes 30 seconds. Thanks!"

Send within 2 hours of job completion — that's when customers are happiest and most likely to respond. GoFieldWise sets this up automatically.

Getting Your Website to Rank for the Right Keywords

Most trades businesses either have no website or have one that Google can't read properly. Here's what a page 1-worthy homepage looks like.

The 5 Places Keywords Must Appear

Title tag	Must include your trade + city. Example: "HVAC Repair Tulsa OK Smith's Heating & Cooling"
H1 heading	Must match what people actually search. Example: "HVAC Repair in Tulsa — Same Day Service Available"
First paragraph	Mention your trade, city, and 2-3 main services within the first 100 words.
Meta description	155 characters max. Include trade, city, and a reason to click.
Image alt text	Every photo should have a description that includes your trade and city.

High-Value Keywords by Trade

Trade	Primary Keywords to Target
HVAC	HVAC repair [city], AC repair near me, furnace repair [city], emergency AC [city]
Plumbing	Emergency plumber [city], plumber near me, drain cleaning [city], water heater repair [city]
Electrical	Electrician [city], panel upgrade [city], EV charger installation [city], licensed electrician near me
Roofing	Roofing company [city], roof repair [city], storm damage roof [city], roof replacement [city]

Cleaning	House cleaning [city], cleaning service near me, move out cleaning [city], maid service [city]
Landscaping	Lawn care [city], landscaping company [city], lawn mowing service [city], landscape design [city]

What Page 1 Is Worth — by Trade

Here's the math most business owners never do. Page 1 isn't just about pride — it's the difference between a thriving business and one that's constantly struggling for leads.

Trade	Avg Job Value	Missed Calls/Mo (Page 2)	Revenue at Stake
HVAC	\$350	40-60 calls	\$14,000-\$21,000/mo
Plumbing	\$280	35-55 calls	\$9,800-\$15,400/mo
Electrical	\$500	25-40 calls	\$12,500-\$20,000/mo
Roofing	\$8,500	8-15 jobs	\$68,000-\$127,500/mo
Cleaning	\$160	50-80 calls	\$8,000-\$12,800/mo
Landscaping	\$220	30-50 calls	\$6,600-\$11,000/mo

These numbers assume a conservative 20-30% close rate — the national average for inbound local service calls. If your team closes at 40%+, the revenue at stake is even higher.

The Roofing Math

Roofing stands out because the job values are so much higher. A roofing company ranking on page 2 during a single hail storm season can miss \$500,000+ in insurance replacement jobs. One good storm season at page 1 can change a business entirely.

How GoFieldWise Does This For You

Everything in this guide is what we implement for every client. You don't need to learn SEO — you need to run your business. We handle the rest.

Starter Site — \$497 setup + \$200/mo

For businesses with no website or a site that can't be saved.

- ✓ New website built to rank for your trade + city
- ✓ Google Business Profile setup and full optimization
- ✓ Google Analytics and Search Console setup
- ✓ 20 local citation submissions
- ✓ Monthly SEO maintenance and ranking report

Local Dominator — \$397/mo

For businesses with an existing site that needs to rank higher.

- ✓ Full on-page SEO audit and fixes applied to your site
- ✓ Google Business Profile optimization
- ✓ Keyword targeting for your trade and city
- ✓ Monthly content and citation building
- ✓ Monthly ranking report with specific keyword positions

Market Leader — \$697/mo

For businesses ready to dominate their entire market.

- ✓ Everything in Local Dominator
- ✓ Weekly Google Business Profile posts
- ✓ Link building and authority growth
- ✓ Competitor monitoring and counter-strategy
- ✓ Expansion to surrounding city keywords

No Contracts. Cancel Anytime. Everything Handled by Email.

No sales calls. No Zoom. No pressure. Just reply to this email to get started.

Your Next Steps

Here's exactly what to do after reading this guide:

Step 1

Run the free tools

Go to gofieldwise.com and use our free SEO audit, rank checker, GBP health check, and competitor peek. Takes 5 minutes and shows you exactly where you stand right now.

Step 2

Fix your GBP today

Use the checklist on page 4. You can complete most of it in 30 minutes and see results within 2-4 weeks.

Step 3

Start asking for reviews

Text the review request template from page 5 to your last 10 customers today. Even 5 new reviews can move you up on Maps.

Step 4

Reply to this email

If you want us to handle everything — reply to biz@gofieldwise.com. We'll tell you exactly what we'd do for your business specifically.

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